

few have the time and resources to do it. But VR may present the next best solution though. Using your smartphone and a budget VR headset you too can explore the world right from your couch. And don't just stop at the world, there are dozens of VR experiences and tours out there that not only show you around various places on our little Blue Planet but there are also a plethora of experiences that take you out into space to explore our solar system, galaxy and other iconic locations of our universe.

GET ADVENTUROUS

We have all seen those videos of people cycling or skiing down perilous slopes at absurd speeds, or jumping out of planes in wingsuits. We might have also wished to do that at some point but let's be honest



most of us don't have the skill or the courage it might take to really do that. It is still something that would be fantastic to experience though and VR might just help in that department. For wimps like us, and for some of that sweet internet fame, people have actually recorded themselves using 360-degree cameras doing some of the most ridiculous adventure sports out there. And you can view those for free. All you have to do is strap on that VR headset, play that video and live vicariously through them. You of course won't be able to interact with the elements like feeling the wind in your hair, but if you have a friend kind enough to point a leaf blower at you, you can have that covered as well.

ENJOY LIVE PERFORMANCES

With some of the other awesome things we have already mentioned,



you can probably imagine attending live performances from your favourite artists in VR. That tech is still a bit in the future but it is something that can be explored for

the benefit of both the performing artist and their fans. Imagine this. A concert venue with strategically placed 360-degree cameras that are uploading their footage live across the world to the VR Headsets of fans who can see and maybe even feel the electrifying atmosphere of a rock or heavy metal concert. The benefit for the artist and event organisers is that they can sell more tickets to their event which is obviously more money for them and fans can better track the tours of their favourite artists without having to travel over the world.

GAMING

Now, there are a few ways you can play games using a VR headset. The

simplest and most obvious way to go about doing it is to search games for Google Cardboard as most of them would not require dedicated VR

controllers. What you might need though is a controller that works with Android like the Xbox 360 controller or controllers from other brands that can be used with smartphones. The other way to play games in VR is with an app like Trinus Cardboard VR. This app connects your phone to a computer and creates a VR environment on your smartphone of the game running on your computer. So in essence your smartphone turns into a display output device that also converts the displayed stuff into VR. One thing to note is that it won't convert your non-VR games into VR but just display the game in VR. So you won't be able to look around in the game using this method but it will surely give you a more immersive gaming experience as opposed to playing the same game using your computer's display.

With the Metaverse gaining traction over the last few months and Covid being an ever-present threat since the last two years (yes, it's only been two years), VR is going to become more and more prominent in our daily lives. So it might be a good idea to check it out and familiarise yourself with the experience



and get used to a big chunky device stuck to your face. And getting into it is super easy as well thanks to the omnipresence of smartphones and budget VR headsets. 